

Planning Business Messages



Effective Business Messages

Purposeful

Audience-Centered

Concise



Three-Step Writing Process



Figure 3.1 The Three-Step Writing Process

Situation

As the manager of a small marketing agency, you've noticed that employees have been missing project deadlines due to unclear instructions and communication gaps. To streamline workflow and improve collaboration, you've decided to implement WorkFlow Pro, a new project management software designed to help everyone stay organized and on schedule. This software is set to go live on November 15, and employees are required to install it on their work computers by November 10.

To ensure a smooth transition, you've scheduled a mandatory training session titled WorkFlow Pro Basics on November 12 at 2:00 PM in the main conference room. This session will be led by a software expert and will cover essential features and tips.

Some employees are known to feel hesitant about new technology, so you're aiming to make the transition as easy as possible. You'll be sending a business message to all employees, explaining why this change is necessary, how WorkFlow Pro will benefit their daily work, and encouraging them to attend the training session to learn the basics.

Analyze Your Purpose

Right Timing?

Right delivery method?

General Purpose

*(To inform, to persuade,
or to collaborate with
Audience)*

Specific Purpose

*(What specific
purpose are you trying
to accomplish?)*

Realistic purpose?

Is it acceptable in the org?

Develop an Audience Profile

- **Identify primary audience**
- **Determine size**
- **Determine composition (Background, education??)**
- **Gauge level of understanding**
- **Project expectations and preferences (What do they want?)**
- **Estimate probable reaction (what to do for skeptical response? Favorable response?)**

Gather Information

**Formal
Sources**

**Opinions
of Others**

**Employees
or Customers**

Interviews

**Company
Files**

**Audience
Input**

Provide Information

Complete

*(Who, what, when,
where,
why, and how.)*

Accurate

*(A date provided
Is a promise made!)*

Pertinent

(Address Interests)

Ethical

*(Avoid unnecessary
Omission!)*

Business Communication Channels and Media

Oral Channel	Written Channel
•Face-to-Face •Telephone •Meetings •Voice Mail •Videotape •Teleconferencing	•Memos •Letters •Reports •E-mail •Websites •Instant Messages

Selecting the Best Channel and Medium



- Style and tone
(Formal/Informal?)
- Feedback
- Audience perception
- Time (urgent?)
- Cost
- Audience expectation

Relating to the Audience

**"You"
Attitude**

**Positive
Tone**

Credibility

**Polite
Treatment**

**Bias-Free
Language**

**Corporate
Image**

The “You” Attitude

Instead of This	Use This
To help us process this order, we must ask for another copy of the requisition.	So that your order can be filled promptly, please send another copy of the requisition.
Instead of This	Use This
You should never use that type of paper in the copy machine.	That type of paper doesn't work very well in the copy machine.

Emphasize the Positive

Instead of This	Use This
It is impossible to repair your vacuum cleaner today.	Your vacuum cleaner will be ready by Tuesday.
Instead of This	Use This
• Cheap merchandise • Toilet paper • Elderly person	• Bargain prices • Bathroom tissue • Senior citizen

Be Polite

Instead of This

You really fouled things up with that last computer run.

Use This

Let's review what went wrong so that the next computer run goes smoothly.

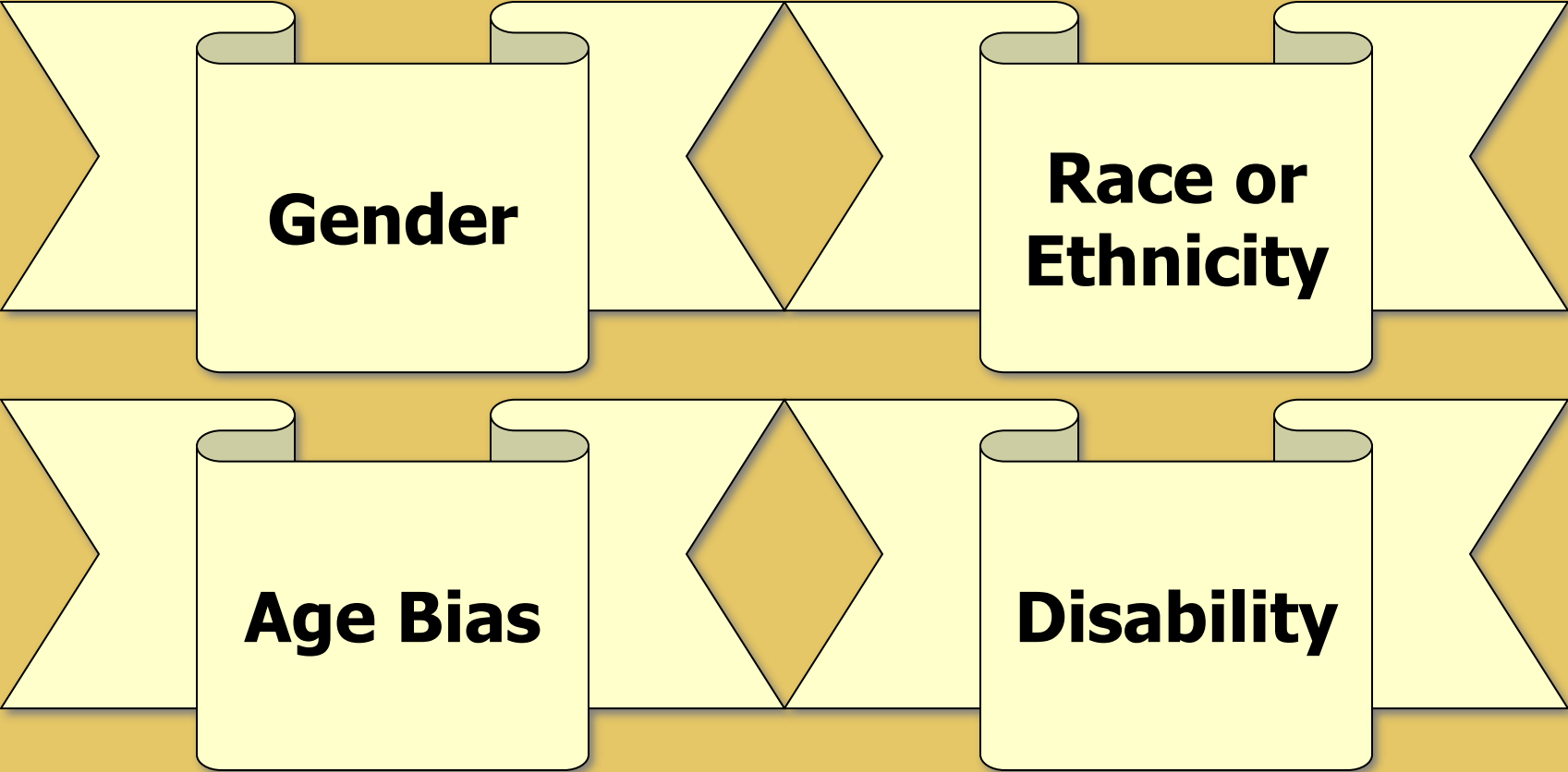
Instead of This

You've been sitting on our order for two weeks. We need it now!

Use This

We are eager to receive our order. When can we expect delivery?

Use Bias-Free Language



Gender

**Race or
Ethnicity**

Age Bias

Disability

Examples	Unacceptable	Preferable
Gender Bias		
Using words containing <i>man</i>	Man-made	Artificial, synthetic, manufactured, constructed, human-made
	Mankind	Humanity, human beings, human race, people
	Manpower	Workers, workforce
	Businessman	Executive, manager, businessperson, professional
	Salesman	Sales representative, salesperson
	Foreman	Supervisor
Using female-gender words	Actress, stewardess	Actor, flight attendant
Using special designations	Woman doctor, male nurse	Doctor, nurse
Using <i>he</i> to refer to "everyone"	The average worker ... he	The average worker ... he or she
		OR
		Average workers ... they
Identifying roles with gender	The typical executive spends four hours of his day in meetings.	Most executives spend four hours a day in meetings.
	The consumer ... she	Consumers ... they
	The nurse/teacher ... she	Nurses/teachers ... they
Identifying women by marital status	Mrs. Norm Lindstrom	Maria Lindstrom
		OR
	Norm Lindstrom and Ms. Drake	Ms. Maria Lindstrom
		Norm Lindstrom and Maria Drake
		OR
		Mr. Lindstrom and Ms. Drake

Racial and Ethnic Bias

Assigning stereotypes

Not surprisingly, Shing-Tung Yau excels in mathematics.

Shing-Tung Yau excels in mathematics.

Identifying people by race or ethnicity

Mario M. Cuomo, Italian-American politician and ex-governor of New York

Mario M. Cuomo, politician and ex-governor of New York

Age Bias

Including age when irrelevant

Mary Kirazy, 58, has just joined our trust department.

Mary Kirazy has just joined our trust department.

Disability Bias

Putting the disability before the person

Disabled workers face many barriers on the job.

Workers with physical disabilities face many barriers on the job.

An epileptic, Tracy has no trouble doing her job.

Tracy's epilepsy has no effect on her job performance.

Establish Credibility

Show Your Understanding

Explain Your Credentials

Avoid Exaggerating

Believe in Yourself

Project the Company's Image

- Be a spokesperson
- Convey the right impression
- Minimize your own views
- Maximize company interests



Thanks!

Do you have any questions?

CONSULTATION HOURS

Sunday and Tuesday

8:00 AM – 9:30 AM, 12:20 PM – 1:30 PM

Monday

10:50 AM – 1:30 PM

Wednesday

10:50 AM – 2:50 PM

COMMUNICATION

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